Chapter 5

Cascading Style Sheets

It’s hard to talk about front-end web development without talking about Cascading Style Sheets (CSS) and their ability to alter and improve the user experience. As CSS has gotten more powerful over the years, it’s made it possible to create amazing layouts and effects with less JavaScript code and more CSS styling. Because of the power of CSS, integration with CSS has become an increasingly important part of front-end development. In this chapter, we’re going to take a look at how we can make CSS part of our build and use it to add neat effects, and further make our components self-contained.

CSS is a big topic, and covering all of it is well beyond the scope of this book. As such, I’m going to assume you are familiar with the rough basics of how CSS works and spend this chapter focusing on three issues:

- How to integrate CSS with our build tools using the cssbundling-rails gem and Tailwind CSS
- How to use CSS animations to augment the interactivity of our JavaScript
- How to declare our CSS inside our JavaScript tools, especially in React, where it can be useful to scope CSS to React components

Don’t worry; if you don’t feel fully versed on how CSS works, Learn CSS Layout has a lot of exercises that show how CSS spacing works.[37] Also try the ezine Hell Yes, CSS.[38]